

# Kian Asgharzadeh

Piano Performer, Composer, Artist & Leader

310.896.1163    kian-asgh@berkeley.edu    2109 Kala Bagai Way, Berkeley, CA 94704

**PROFILE**    Creative and driven composer and pianist exploring the intersections of classical forms, contemporary sound, cultural and individual identity, and non-linguistic human experiences. As an active performer, researcher, and artistic collaborator in multiple disciplines, I create and curate multimedia works that bridge auditory, visual, and physical works. As demonstrated by my past in collaborative audio and kinesthetic environments, community outreach, teaching positions, and cultural research, I am committed to cultural conservation and technical mastery.

## LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

**President | Salsa At Cal, Professional Collegiate Latin Dance Team** **Berkeley, California | 2024-Present**

University organization dedicated to creating initiatives for Berkeley students dedicated to learning about history, culture, and practice of Afro-Latin and contemporary dance forms.

- Oversee professional choreography routines, teach beginner and intermediate lessons for students, create and guide projects, fundraisers, events and collaborations with other organizations for lower-income communities in the Bay Area,
- Raised \$2000+ in fundraising efforts for club activities and community events through creative marketing strategy
- Collaboration across multiple teams and organizations to imagine and execute 20+ free events for low income communities
- Uplifting students through cultural/historical appreciation and technical mastery through the arts

**Creative Director | Various Media and Creative liaisons** **International | 2023-Present**

- Producing a performance art film directed exploring physical embodiment and formlessness, incorporating Japanese Butoh-Fu elements
- Composed and premiered three original piano works, The Fountain, Remembrance, and Sonata Patetico, blending classical techniques with contemporary multimedia elements in the Bay Area
- Scored original music for an international short film “Crush” premiered in Sweden and an interactive performance art piece at UC Berkeley
- Choreographed a 5.5 minute Latin dance routine performed by students at internationally recognized dance festivals (SF Salsa Festival)

**Lead Pianist | UC Berkeley Latin And Caribbean Ensemble** **Berkeley, California | 2024-Present**

Lead pianist for the Cal Latin and Caribbean Ensemble, performing in jazz and Latin styles such as salsa, cumbia, samba, and bachata

- Anchored rhythm section as Lead Pianist for university events and performances
- Showcased advanced Jazz and Latin improvisation techniques during live performances
- Facilitated ensemble cohesion through team-building initiatives and guided appreciation of Latin and Caribbean musical traditions

**Piano Instructor | Music Box School** **Redondo Beach, California | 2023-Present**

Music Lessons and School in Redondo Beach serving South Bay cities with lessons in Voice, Piano, Guitar, Strings, Violin, Cello, choirs, bands, music theory, and more. Intensive work with students over summer sessions

- Designed and delivered individualized lesson plans for students aged 5-15 tailored to each student’s skill level and learning style.
- Instructed students in foundational and advanced techniques across both jazz, classical, and contemporary piano repertoires
- Prepared students for solo recitals and performances within the South Bay

## EDUCATION

**University of California Berkeley | Berkeley, California | 2024-2026**

*Bachelor of Music, with Emphasis in Composition*

**Cal State University Long Beach | Long Beach, California | 2022-2024**

*Coursework towards B.A. of Music with Emphasis in Piano Performance*

**University of Birmingham | Birmingham, UK | 2024**

*Study Abroad Program in Music Studies, Psychology, and Philosophy*

## SELECTED HONORS AND AWARDS

- Bob Cole Scholarship Recipient
- Honorable Mention, George and Beverly
  - August Piano Competition CSULB 2023
- Selected for CSULB Music History Summer Program
  - Austria 2023
- Gold Prize Winner,
  - Euterpe Music Awards 2024

## LANGUAGE COMPETENCES

- English
- Fluent (speaking, reading, writing)
- Farsi
- Fluent (speaking, reading, writing)
- Spanish
- Basic (speaking, reading, writing)